

Forgiveness and reconciliation Key philosophical and ethical concepts: • Forgiveness • Justice, fairness and injustice • Reconciliation	• The concepts of forgiveness and reconciliation • Different Buddhist teachings and beliefs about justice, forgiveness and reconciliation • The impact of teachings about justice, forgiveness and reconciliation on individuals, communities and society • Whether forgiveness is either possible or desirable • Different Buddhist attitudes towards justice, forgiveness and reconciliation • The concepts of justice and injustice, including: ◦ The relationship between peace and a just society ◦ Social justice and injustice ◦ Ways in which Buddhists work for social justice ◦ Ways in which Buddhists view social injustice Learners should be aware of the justifications Buddhists give for different views, attitudes and understandings, from the perspectives of different Buddhist groups.	• Forgiveness can also be seen as a wider part of Mahayana Buddhist ideas concerning compassion and wisdom. Loving kindness (metta-bhavana) • The Dhammapada 1:3–4: ◦ “He abused me, he struck me, he overcame me, he robbed me’ – in those who harbour such thoughts hatred will never cease.” ◦ “He abused me, he struck me, he overcame me, he robbed me’ – in those who do not harbour such thoughts hatred will cease.”
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Dialogue between religious and non-religious beliefs and attitudes		
Area of study	Content Learners should have studied the following:	Suggested sources of wisdom and authority (Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate sources of wisdom and authority)